HackGB 2026
Participant Guide

Welcome!

Thank you for participating in **HackGB 2026**, the first-ever 24-hour collegiate hackathon hosted at the University of Wisconsin–Green Bay! Over the next 24 continuous hours, students, developers, designers, and innovators from across the country will collaborate, learn, and build impactful technology.

This guide is your official roadmap for the weekend. It covers essential logistics, run of show, track descriptions, submission rules, judging criteria, mentorship support, and venue policies.

We hope this guide answers any questions you might have, but feel free to send a message on **Discord** or send us an email at **contact@hackgb.com** if you have any questions! You can also visit **hackgb.com** for more information, such as our **FAQ section, schedule, and mentor/judge bios**.

Note that all times on this document are in CST (GMT - 6:00).

We are excited to have you as part of the very first HackGB. Let's build something impactful.

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About the Event

HackGB 2026 is a fully in-person, 24-hour collegiate hackathon taking place **October 17–18, 2026**, at the **University of Wisconsin–Green Bay**. It brings together students from UW–Green Bay and colleges across the country for a weekend of building, learning, experimentation, and collaboration.

Throughout the event, participants will work individually or in teams to turn ideas into real projects across **Environment & Sustainability, Education, Industrial Innovation, and Healthcare & Wellness**. Hackers will also have access to workshops, mentors, technical resources, sponsor challenges, and opportunities to connect with fellow students and industry professionals.

Whether you are an experienced hacker or attending your first hackathon, HackGB is an opportunity to **learn new skills, meet new people, experiment with technology, and build something impactful within 24 hours**.

Event Overview

- **Dates:** Saturday, October 17 – Sunday, October 18, 2026
- **Duration:** 24 Continuous Hours (Check-in at 08:00 AM; Hacking Kickoff at 12:00 PM Saturday (ends at 12:00 PM Sunday)
- **Venue:** Brown County STEM Innovation Center, UW-Green Bay Campus (2019 Technology Way, Green Bay, WI 54311)

Pre-Event To-Dos

1. **Join the Official Discord:** Follow the invite link sent to your registration email. Discord is our primary hub for live announcements.
2. **Setup Accounts:** Make sure you have active accounts on GitHub and Devpost.
3. **Review the Schedule & Tracks:** Familiarize yourself with our 4 challenge tracks and workshop timings.

Packing Checklist

- **Required:** Valid Student ID or Government-issued Photo ID (required at check-in).
- **Tech & Gear:** Laptop, charging cables, phone charger, power strips/extension cords, and any specialized hardware (microcontrollers, sensors, IoT kits) you intend to work on.
- **Personal Items:** Reusable water bottle, warm layers, comfortable shoes, and personal medications.
- **Overnight Comfort:** Sleeping bag, small pillow, or blanket for the designated quiet rest area.
- **Prohibited Items:** Desktop PC towers, extra external monitors, cooking appliances, weapons, and alcoholic beverages/drugs.

Venue, Infrastructure & Wi-Fi

HackGB will take place across two UW–Green Bay facilities. Please pay attention to the operating hours for each building, especially during the overnight portion of the hackathon.

Building Access

Brown County STEM Innovation Center
This is the **main HackGB venue and hacking space**. The STEM Innovation Center will remain accessible to HackGB participants **24 hours throughout the event**, including overnight. Most hacking, mentoring and team activities will take place here.

University Union
The University Union Phoenix Room will be available as an additional hacking space on Saturday, alongside regular weekend operating hours:

- **Saturday:** 8:30 AM – 11:00 PM
- **Sunday:** 8:30 AM – 11:00 PM

Participants may use the Union while it is open for available campus services, food, and common areas.

Outside of the opening and closing ceremonies, participants should return to the STEM Innovation Center or University Union for HackGB activities.

Parking & Transportation

Parking: Free parking is available in the **Laboratory Sciences parking lot**, within walking distance of the STEM Innovation Center.

Public Transportation: Green Bay Metro provides bus service to the UW–Green Bay campus. Participants traveling from hotels or other locations in Green Bay can use the **Transit app** to plan their trip and view routes, schedules, and real-time bus information. Regular fare is **$2 per ride**, with a **$4 day pass** available.

Note: Green Bay Metro does not provide regular Sunday service, except on NFL home-game Sundays. Please plan your Sunday transportation accordingly. For current routes, schedules, and service information, visit Green Bay Metro.

Overnight Access

The **STEM Innovation Center is the designated overnight HackGB space**. Participants staying overnight should remain within approved HackGB areas and follow all posted building and event guidelines.

Keep your **HackGB T-shirt and/or participant ID (lanyard) visible** throughout the event, as it may be used to identify registered participants and organizers.

Please do not prop open exterior doors or allow unauthorized individuals into event spaces.

Wi-Fi & Connectivity

1. Eduroam

Recommended for students from any university. Connect using your university credentials.

2. HackGB Dedicated Wi-Fi

A dedicated Wi-Fi network will be available for everyone attending HackGB, including participants, judges, mentors, volunteers, and organizers. Attendees who do not have university credentials are especially encouraged to use this network. Wi-Fi credentials and connection instructions will be provided during event check-in.

3. UWGB-Guest

Available to everyone attending HackGB. If you are unable to connect to either of the networks above, you can use UWGB-Guest. Please note that this network may have more limited bandwidth during the event.

If you experience any connectivity issues, please contact a HackGB organizer for assistance.

Check-In & Badging

- **Time:** Saturday, October 17, 2026, **8:00 AM – 11:00 AM**
- **Location:** 2019 Technology Wy, Green Bay, WI 54311, STEM Innovation Center Front Lobby
- **Process:**
    a. Present your student/photo ID and registration confirmation email at the check-in desk.
    b. Receive your HackGB Participant ID and T-shirt.
    c. After checking in at the main lobby, you can get settled in the hacking space within the STEM Innovation Center or stay in the lobby to meet and connect with your teammates. We'll then head to University Union together for the Welcome & Opening Ceremony.

Late Check-ins: If you are unable to arrive during the scheduled check-in hours (8:00 AM – 11:00 AM), please notify the HackGB organizing team in advance. Late check-ins may be accommodated for a few hours after the official check-in window with prior notice. Please contact us ahead of time to make arrangements. Participants arriving late without prior notice may not be guaranteed check-in.

Full 24-Hour Event Schedule

Saturday, October 17, 2026

Time	Activity	Location
8:00 AM – 11:00 AM	Participant Check-In & Networking Session	Lobby, STEM Innovation Center
11:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Opening Ceremony & Keynote Address	Christie Theatre, University Union
12:00 PM	**Hacking Officially Begins!**	STEM Innovation Center / Everywhere
12:30 PM – 1:30 PM	Lunch Service	Social House, University Union
1:00 PM – 1:30 PM	Technical Workshop & API Deep Dive - Modal	1965 Room, University Union
1:30 PM – 2:15 PM	From Demo to Production– Auto-scale Your AI Agent on Cloud Run - Kiruthika Subramani	Phoenix Room B & C, University Union
2:30 PM – 3:15 PM	Company Info & Recruitment Session - FTI	1965 Room, University Union

Time	Activity	Location
3:30 PM – 4:30 PM	From Screen to Machine - Bay Tek (The Village)	1965 Room, University Union
5:00 PM – 7:00 PM	Dinner Break (No Workshops)	Social House, University Union
7:00 PM – 7:45 PM	Hacking with GitHub Copilot (Major League Hacking)	1965 Room, University Union
8:00 PM – 8:30 PM	TechTogether Meetup & Community Session (Major League Hacking)	1965 Room, University Union
8:30 PM - 9:00 PM	Raffle Draw #1	Phoenix Room
10:00 PM	Return to STEM Innovation Center	All hackers return to the **STEM Innovation Center** for overnight hacking.
11:59 PM	Initial (Draft) Devpost Submission	STEM Innovation Center

Sunday, October 18, 2026

Time	Activity	Location
1:00 AM - 1:45 AM	Raffle Draw #2	STEM Innovation Center Hacking Space
8:00 AM - 9:30 AM	Breakfast Provided	STEM Innovation Center Hacking Space
12:00 PM	Hacking Ends & Submissions Due	All project submissions must be submitted on Devpost by 12:00 PM.
12:00 PM – 1:00 PM	Lunch Service	STEM Innovation Center
1:00 PM – 4:30 PM	**Project Showcase Expo & Judging**	STEM Innovation Center Hacking Space
5:00 PM – 6:00 PM	**Closing Ceremony, Awards Presentation & Raffle Draw #3**	Christie Theatre, University Union

Meals, Snacks & Refreshments

Meals will be provided to HackGB participants throughout the event. Please refer to the schedule for serving times and locations.

- Saturday Lunch: 12:30 PM – 1:30 PM — Social House
- Saturday Dinner: 5:00 PM – 7:00 PM — Social House
- Sunday Breakfast: 8:00 AM – 9:30 AM — STEM Innovation Center
- Sunday Lunch: 12:00 PM – 1:00 PM — STEM Innovation Center

Snacks and refreshments will also be available during the hackathon. Participants are encouraged to bring a reusable water bottle and stay hydrated throughout the event.

If you have any dietary restrictions or food allergies, please notify a HackGB organizer.

Team Guidelines

- **Team Size:** 1 to 4 members. We strongly encourage hacking in teams of 2 to 4.
- **Eligibility:** All college, university, and high school students (18+ or with waiver), as well as recent graduates (within 1 year since graduation).
- **Finding Teammates:** Use the **#team-finding** channel on Discord or attend the **Team Matching Mixer** on Saturday after the Opening Ceremony.
- **Devpost Linking:** Every member must join your project on Devpost before the deadline to be eligible for prizes.

MLH Resources

This year, **HackGB is proud to partner with Major League Hacking (MLH)** to support hackers throughout the weekend. MLH is the official student hackathon league and will provide additional resources, mentorship, technical support, and activities to help you make the most of your HackGB experience.

Here's how you can connect with MLH during **HackGB**:

- **Discord:** Visit the **#ask-mlh** channel under the **Support** section to ask questions, get support, and connect with MLH representatives.
- **MLH Help Desk:** Find an MLH representative in person at the designated **MLH Help Desk** during the event.
- **Hardware Hub:** Located near the MLH Help Desk, the Hardware Hub will provide eligible hardware and other resources that teams may check out for use in their projects.
    - Supplies may be limited, so we strongly recommend checking out any hardware you need as early as possible and only taking materials your team plans to use.
- **MLH Challenges & Resources:** MLH may also provide sponsor challenges, technical resources, workshops, and other opportunities throughout the weekend. Watch Discord and the HackGB schedule for updates.

All HackGB participants are expected to follow the **MLH Code of Conduct**, which helps ensure a safe, respectful, welcoming, and inclusive environment for everyone throughout the event.

Hacking Tracks & Themes

HackGB features **four main tracks** alongside several **additional specialty and sponsored tracks**, giving participants multiple opportunities to showcase their creativity and compete for prizes.

Every project must be submitted to **exactly one of the four main tracks**:

Tracks	Description
Environment & Sustainability	Build solutions that address environmental challenges through technology, including climate action, renewable energy, waste reduction, conservation, and smarter resource management.
Education	Create tools that make learning more accessible, engaging, and effective, including platforms that expand access to education and improve digital literacy.
Industrial	Develop solutions that improve how industries operate, from modernizing supply chains and manufacturing processes to improving efficiency and workplace safety.
Healthcare & Wellness	Explore how technology can expand patient care, improve mental wellness, increase accessibility, and help manage healthcare and clinical data responsibly.

Additional & Sponsored Tracks

In addition to your main track, you may select multiple additional tracks, including specialty categories such as Hardware, Beginner, Solo, and UI/UX, as well as sponsor challenges from Modal, Lovable, and Major League Hacking (MLH).

Each additional track may have its own eligibility requirements, technology integrations, and judging criteria.

Prizes & Awards

HackGB features a variety of prizes across four award categories:

1. **Main Track Prizes:** Awarded to the best project in each of the four main tracks.
2. **Overall Prizes:** Recognize outstanding projects in categories such as Best Overall Hack, Best Solo Hack, Best Beginner Hack, Best UI/UX Hack, and Best Hardware Hack.
3. **Sponsor Prizes:** Awarded for innovative and effective use of sponsoring partners' technologies.
4. **MLH Sponsored Prizes:** Additional awards for projects that meet specific MLH-sponsored challenge requirements.

Important Submission Rules

- ➢ Each project must select one main track only.
- ➢ Teams may select multiple additional and sponsored tracks if eligible.
- ➢ Each team submits one project, regardless of the number of tracks selected.
- ➢ Projects must satisfy the eligibility and technical requirements of every selected track.
- ➢ All submissions will be evaluated according to HackGB's judging criteria and any applicable sponsor-specific requirements.

Explore All Tracks & Prizes

For detailed track descriptions, eligibility requirements, judging considerations, and the complete list of prizes, please refer to our dedicated document:

[View HackGB 2026 – Hacking Tracks & Prizes]

We encourage all participants to review the available tracks and prizes before submitting their projects to ensure they don't miss any opportunities!

Submission Checklist

All projects must be submitted via the official **HackGB Devpost** by **Sunday, October 18, 2026 at 12:00 PM CT**.

- ☑ **Code Freshness:** All project code was created during the 24 hours of HackGB.
- ☑ **Public GitHub Repository:** Link to a public repository with source code.
- ☑ **Project Description:** Clear overview of problem, solution, and architecture.
- ☑ **Demo Video:** Max 3-minute video showcasing your working demo.
- ☑ **AI Disclosure:** Disclose any AI assistants or third-party APIs used in the README.

Judging Overview

Showcase Expo Format

- **Time:** Sunday, 1:00 PM – 4:30 PM CT
- **Format:** Judging will follow a **science-fair-style expo**. Each team will be assigned a **table number** where they will set up and present their project.
- **Stay at Your Table:** At least one team member must remain at the assigned table during judging. Judges will visit your table to evaluate your project.
- **Pitch Timing:** Be prepared to give a **3-minute project presentation**, followed by approximately **2 minutes of judge Q&A**.
- **Sponsor Judging:** Teams participating in sponsor challenges may also be visited by additional sponsor judges or representatives.
- **Multiple Awards:** A team or individual may be eligible for **multiple awards**, including overall, track, specialty, and sponsor awards, depending on eligibility.

Judging Criteria

At HackGB 2026, we believe great projects combine creativity, technical execution, and meaningful impact. Whether you're building your first project or tackling a complex technical challenge, our judges want to see how you turn your ideas into solutions.

Projects will be evaluated based on the following five criteria:

1. Innovation & Creativity (20%)

How original and creative is your solution?

- Does your project introduce a unique idea or a fresh approach to solving a problem?
- Does it demonstrate creative thinking or an innovative use of technology?
- Does it deliver an **“Aha! Moment”** – something clever, unexpected, or impressive that makes judges think, *“Wow, that's a great idea!”*?

2. Technical Implementation (25%)

How well did you build your solution?

- Does your project demonstrate effective use of technologies, frameworks, or tools?
- How functional and technically sound is your prototype?
- Did your team overcome meaningful technical challenges?
- Can you explain how your solution works and the technical decisions behind it?

3. Impact & Problem-Solving (25%)

What problem are you solving, and why does it matter?

- Does your project address a clearly defined, real-world problem?
- How effectively does your solution solve that problem?
- Who benefits from your solution, and what difference could it make?
- Is there potential for your project to grow or create lasting impact?

4. User Experience & Design (15%)

How easy and intuitive is your solution to use?

- Is your project user-friendly, accessible, and thoughtfully designed?
- Does the design support the needs of your intended users?
- Is the overall experience clear, functional, and engaging?

5. Presentation & Demonstration (15%)

How effectively can you showcase your project?

- Can you clearly communicate the problem, solution, and technologies used?
- Can you demonstrate your project's key features?
- Is your presentation organized, engaging, and easy to understand?
- Can your team confidently answer judges' questions?

Mentorship & Support

- **Discord:** Post in **#ask-mentors** under **Support Category** with your table number and tech stack to request a mentor.
- Developer Resources: Refer to this document to find resources to work on a project.

Midnight Activities & Raffle

There will be three raffle draws during HackGB:

- Raffle Draw #1: **Saturday, 8:30 PM–9:00 PM** — Phoenix Room
- Raffle Draw #2: **Sunday, 1:00 AM–1:45 AM** — STEM Innovation Center, Hacking Space
- Raffle Draw #3: During the Closing Ceremony, **after the Award Ceremony**

Raffle Rules

- All checked-in participants are automatically eligible for the raffle.
- We strongly encourage everyone who is available to be present at the venue during the raffle draw.
- If a winner is not present, we will also announce their name on Discord. The winner should contact an organizer to claim their prize.
- Once a participant wins a raffle prize, their name will be removed from all remaining raffle draws, giving others a chance to win.

- Mentors, judges, sponsors, and organizers are not eligible to participate in the raffle.

Accommodations & Venue Policies

- **Prayer & Religious Accommodations:** If you need a quiet or private space for prayer or religious observance during HackGB, please let an organizer know. We will do our best to arrange an appropriate space for you.
- **Other Accommodations:** If you need accessibility, dietary, religious, or other accommodation during the event, please contact a HackGB organizer. We will work with you to help accommodate your needs.
- **AI Policy:** Tools such as GitHub Copilot and Gemini are permitted but must be disclosed. Projects must represent the team's original engineering work.
- **Code of Conduct:** HackGB enforces a zero-tolerance policy against harassment. Please respect all participants, volunteers, organizers, mentors, judges, sponsors, and venue staff.

Contact Information & Support

If you have any questions, comments, or concerns during **HackGB**, please contact the HackGB team through one of the following:

- **Email:** contact@hackgb.com
- **Discord:** Tag **@Organizer** for event-related questions or **@Mentor** for technical and project support
- **In Person:** Visit the **Help Desk Booth at the STEM Innovation Center** for general assistance.

For urgent safety concerns or situations requiring campus police, contact **UW–Green Bay Campus Police at (920) 465-2300**. For immediate life-threatening emergencies, call **911**.

Happy Hacking! Build something incredible at HackGB 2026!